Annual Water Quality Report 2025

Presented by the City of Gilroy Utilities Department



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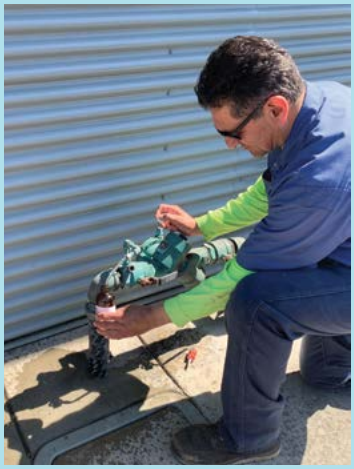
Message to our Customers

The City of Gilroy tests its water for many constituents as required by state and federal regulations. This report shows the results of our monitoring for January 1 to December 31, 2025.

Providing safe, reliable drinking water is one of the City of Gilroy's highest priorities. We are committed to delivering high-quality water that meets or exceeds all Federal and State drinking water standards.

Public water systems are required by the State Water Resources Control Board, Division of Drinking Water, to provide customers with an Annual Water Quality Report. The purpose of this report is to help water users better understand drinking water and the efforts made to protect public health and maintain water quality.

In this report, you will find information about where your water comes from, what was detected through routine testing, and how those results compare to State and Federal drinking water standards. **We are pleased to report that Gilroy's drinking water continues to meet all applicable drinking water quality requirements.**



Water Conservation

Water is a valuable resource, and every drop counts. By using water wisely we can help ensure a reliable water supply for our community now and in the future. Even small changes in daily habits can make a big difference.

The City of Gilroy offers programs, resources, and information to help residents save water both indoors and outdoors. Learn more at www.cityofgilroy.org/waterconservation.

Indoor Water Conservation Tips

- Fix leaking faucets, pipes, and toilets as soon as possible.
- Install water-saving showerheads, faucets, and toilets.
- Run dishwashers and washing machines only when they are full.
- Take shorter showers.
- Turn off the water while brushing your teeth, shaving, or washing fruits and vegetables.
- Avoid using the toilet as a trash can.
- Replace older appliances with high-efficiency models when possible.

Learn about water-saving rebates available through the Santa Clara Valley Water District at www.valleywater.org/rebates.

Outdoor Water Conservation Tips

- Water landscapes only as needed and during the evening or early morning. Outdoor watering is more efficient between 7 p.m. and 3 a.m., and also reduces demand during peak use periods. From November through March: water 1 day per week, and 3 days per week from April through October



- Consider replacing your lawn with water-efficient landscaping. Rebate information is available at www.valleywater.org/landscaperebateprogram.
- Repair leaks in outdoor faucets, hoses, and irrigation systems as soon as possible.
- Use water-efficient irrigation equipment and hose nozzles.
- Wash your car at a commercial car wash that recycles water.
- Sweep leaves, grass clippings, and dirt from driveways and sidewalks instead of using a hose.

2025 Test Results: California drinking water regulations require that water delivered by public water systems be, at all times, wholesome and potable, as required by the Federal and State Safe Drinking Water Acts. To accomplish this mandate, domestic water must meet strict standards. This regulation establishes both primary and secondary Maximum Contaminant Levels (MCLs) for specified microbiological, chemical, and radionuclide contaminants, and it sets the required monitoring frequencies for these contaminants. Primary contaminants are those that may directly pose a risk to human health. Secondary contaminants are those that may affect the aesthetic quality of the drinking water (taste, odor, or color of the water).

Tables 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 list all of the drinking water contaminants that were detected during the most recent sampling for the constituent. The presence of these contaminants in the water does not necessarily indicate that the water poses a heath risk. The SWRCB requires us to monitor for certain contaminants less than once per year because the concentrations of these contaminants are not expected to vary significantly from year to year. Some of the data points, through representative of the water quality, are more than one year old.

TABLE 1 - SAMPLING RESULTS SHOWING THE DETECTION OF COLIFORM BACTERIA 2025

Contaminant (Microbiological)	MCLG	MCL	Detections	No. of Months in Violation	Typical Source of Bacteria
Total Coliform Bacteria	0	More than 5% samples in a month with a detection	1 (in a month)	0	Naturally present in the environment
Fecal Coliform or E. coli	0	A routine sample and a repeat sample detect total coliform and either sample also detects fecal coliform or E. coli	0 (in a year)	0	Human and animal fecal waste

TABLE 2 - CUSTOMER TAP WATER LEAD/COPPER SAMPLING

Contaminant (units)	Sample Date	No. of Samples Collected	90th Percentile Level Detected	No. Sites Exceeding AL	AL	MCLG	Typical Source of Contaminant
Lead (ppb)	5/14/2024	30	0.00	0	15	2	Internal corrosion of household water plumbing systems; discharges from industrial manufacturers; erosion of natural deposits
Copper (ppm)	5/14/2024	30	0.16	0	1.3	0.3	Internal corrosion of household water plumbing systems; erosion of natural deposits; leaching from wood preservatives

TABLE 3 - SAMPLING RESULTS FOR SODIUM AND HARDNESS

Chemical or Constituent (units)	Sample Date	Avg. Level Detected	Range of Detections	MCL	PHG (MCLG)	Typical Source of Contaminant
Sodium (ppm)	2/14/2024	23.14	17–58	none	none	Generally found in ground and surface water
Hardness (ppm)	2/14/2024	237	174–271	none	none	Generally found in ground and surface water

TABLE 4 - DETECTION OF CONTAMINANTS WITH A PRIMARY DRINKING WATER STANDARD

Chemical or Constituent (units)	Date/Frequency	Avg. Level Detected	Range of Detection	MCL	PHG (MCLG)	Typical Source of Contaminant
Fluoride (ppm)	2/14/2024	0.01	ND-0.10	2	1 (NA)	Erosion of natural deposits; water additive which promotes strong teeth; discharge from fertilizer and aluminum factories
Nitrate (N) (ppm)	Quarterly 2025	5.4	3.8-8.3	10	10 (NA)	Runoff and leaching from fertilizer use; leaching from septic tanks, sewage; erosion of natural deposits
Tetrachloroethylene [PCE] (ppb)	Monthly 2025	0.23	ND-1.0	5	0.06 (NA)	Discharge from factories, dry cleaners and auto shops (metal degreaser)
Total Trihalomethanes [TTHMs] (ppb)	Quarterly 2025	6.55	ND-13.8	80	NA (NA)	By-product of drinking water chlorination
Total Haloacetic Acids (HAA5) (ppb)	Quarterly 2025	0.76	ND-3.0	60	NA (NA)	By-product of drinking water chlorination

TABLE 5 - DETECTION OF CONTAMINANTS WITH A SECONDARY DRINKING WATER STANDARD

Chemical or Constituent (units)	Sample Date	Avg. Level Detected	Range of Detections	MCL	PHG (MCLG)	Typical Source of Contaminant
Chloride (ppm)	2/14/2024	29.00	24-40	500	NA (NA)	Runoff/leaching from natural deposits; seawater influence
Specific Conductance (micromhos/cm)	2/14/2024	567	516-618	1600	NA (NA)	Substances that form ions when in water; seawater influence
Sulfate (ppm)	2/14/2024	40.86	32-48	500	NA (NA)	Runoff/leaching from natural deposits, industrial wastes
Total Dissolved Solids [TDS] (ppm)	2/14/2024	339	310-368	1000	NA (NA)	Runoff/leaching from natural deposits

DEFINITIONS

Public Health Goal (PHG): The level of a contaminant in drinking water below which there is no known or expected risk to health. PHGs are set by the California Environmental Protection Agency.

Maximum Contaminant Level Goal (MCLG): The level of a contaminant in drinking water below which there is no known or expected risk to health. MCLGs are set by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency.

Maximum Contaminant Level (MCL): The highest level of a contaminant that is allowed in drinking water. Primary MCLs are set as close to the PHGs (or MCLGs) as is economically and technologically feasible. Secondary MCLs are set to protect the odor, taste, and appearance of drinking water.

Maximum Residual Disinfectant Level Goal (MRDLG): The level of a disinfectant added for water treatment below which there is no known or expected risk to health. MRDLGs are set by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency.

Primary Drinking Water Standards: MCLs and MRDLs for contaminants that affect health along with their monitoring and reporting requirements, and water treatment requirements.

NA: not applicable

ND: not detectable at testing limit

ppm: parts per million or milligrams per liter (mg/L)

ppb: parts per billion or micrograms per liter (ug/L)

ppt: parts per trillion or nanograms per liter (ng/L)

pCi/L: picocuries per liter (a measure of radiation)

Regulatory Action Levels (AL): The concentration of a contaminant which, if exceeded, triggers treatment or other requirements that a water system must follow.

Contaminants

Sources of drinking water include rivers, lakes, streams, ponds, reservoirs, springs, and wells. As water travels over the surface of the land or through the ground, it dissolves naturally occurring minerals and, in some cases, picks up chemicals and substances resulting from the presence of animals or human activity.

In order to ensure that tap water is safe to drink, the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (U.S. EPA) and the State Water Resources Control Board (State Board) prescribe regulations that limit the amount of certain contaminants in water provided by public water systems. The U.S. Food and Drug Administration and California law also establish limits for contaminants in bottled water that provide the same protection for public health.

Contaminants that may be present in source water before we treat it include:

- Microbial contaminants, such as viruses and bacteria, that may come from sewage treatment plants, septic systems, agricultural or livestock operations, and wildlife.
- Inorganic contaminants, such as salts and metals, which can be naturally - occurring or result from urban storm water runoff, industrial or domestic wastewater discharges, oil and gas production, mining or farming.
- Pesticides and herbicides, which may come from a variety of sources such as agricultural, urban storm water runoff, and residential uses.
- Organic Chemical Contaminants, including synthetic and volatile organic chemicals that are byproducts of industrial processes and petroleum production, and can also come from gas stations, urban storm water runoff, agricultural application and septic systems.
- Radioactive contaminants, which can be naturally occurring or be the result of oil and gas production and mining activities.
- Perfluoroalkyl and Polyfluoroalkyl substances, collectively known as “PFAS” are a group of chemicals that have been widely used in industrial applications and consumer products such as carpets, clothing, furniture fabrics, paper packaging for food, firefighting foams, and other materials including waterproof/ stain resistant/ nonstick cookware. Perfluorooctanoic acid (PFOA) and perfluorooctane sulfonate (PFOS) are two common types of PFAS. In order to ensure that tap water is safe to drink, the US Environmental Protection Agency (USEPA) and the SWRCB prescribe regulations that limit the amount of certain contaminants in water provided by public water systems.
- Nitrate in drinking water at levels above 10 mg/L is a health risk for infants less than six months of age. Such nitrate levels in drinking water can interfere with the capacity of the infant’s blood to carry oxygen, resulting in a serious illness; symptoms include shortness of breath and blueness of the skin. Nitrate levels above 10 mg/L may also affect the ability of the blood to carry oxygen in other individuals, such as pregnant women, and those with certain specific enzyme deficiencies. If you are caring for an infant, or you are pregnant, you should ask advice from your health care provider. Nitrate levels may rise quickly for short periods of time because of rainfall or agricultural activity. Drinking water, including bottled water, may reasonably be expected to contain at least small amounts of contaminants. The presence of contaminants does not necessarily indicate that water poses a health risk. More information about contaminants and potential health effects can be obtained by calling the EPA’s Safe Drinking Water Act Hotline (1-800-426-4791).
- Lead - The City of Gilroy conducts lead and copper sampling in accordance with the federal Lead and Copper Rule (LCR) and its Revisions (LCRR), and corresponding requirements under Title 22 CCR. Sampling is conducted at representative residential tap sites throughout the distribution system, with a focus on homes most likely to have lead-containing plumbing materials or service line connections. If present, elevated levels of lead can cause serious health problems, especially for pregnant women and young children. Lead in drinking water is primarily from materials and components associated with service lines and home plumbing. The City of Gilroy is responsible for providing high quality drinking water and removing lead service lines but cannot control the variety of materials used in plumbing components within your home. You share the responsibility for protecting yourself and your family from lead in your home plumbing. You can take responsibility by identifying and removing lead materials within your home plumbing and taking steps to reduce your family’s risk. Before drinking tap water, flush your pipes for several minutes by running your tap, taking a shower, doing laundry, or running a load of dishes. Information on lead in drinking water, testing methods, and steps you can take to minimize exposure is available at www.epa.gov/safewater/lead.



Some people may be more vulnerable to contaminants in drinking water than the general population. Immuno-compromised persons such as persons with cancer undergoing chemotherapy, persons who have undergone organ transplants, people with HIV/AIDS or other immune system disorders, some elderly, and infants can be particularly at risk from infections. These people should seek advice about drinking water from their health care providers.

EPA Standards

The Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) establishes monitoring requirements and maximum contaminant levels. As the EPA develops new standards, California will amend state regulations, which establish water quality requirements for local water supplies. The domestic water supplied by the City of Gilroy meets all current regulations. This report includes the respective Public Health Goal (PHG), or the federal Maximum Contaminant Level Goal (MCLG) for chemicals that do not yet have a PHG.



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System Improvements

To meet the growing needs of our customers, the City of Gilroy is continually evaluating, maintaining and improving our water system.

The City is currently in the design phase of a new well at McCarthy Ranch, located on the south side of the City, to help meet future water demand. The City will expand its fire hydrant inspection program to make sure all City-owned hydrants are working properly and can provide enough water during emergencies. The inspection will also include checking nearby valves, repainting curbs where needed, and ensuring that brush and landscaping are cleared within three feet of each hydrant.

The City is designing six water utility improvement projects to meet current and future water and fire flow demands. Five of the six projects will replace small diameter distribution pipelines with upsized ductile iron pipelines meeting the requirements of the City's pipeline technical specifications. As part of the City's lead service line replacement program, 267 of the 398 identified services with lead connectors have already been proactively replaced. As of April 2026, the City plans to complete all remaining replacements within the next two years and will continue updating service line records to maintain full compliance with Lead and Copper Rule requirements. Check USEPA/Centers for Disease Control (CDC) guidelines on appropriate means to lessen the risk of infection by Cryptosporidium and other microbial contaminants are available from the Safe Drinking Water Hotline (1-800-426-4791).



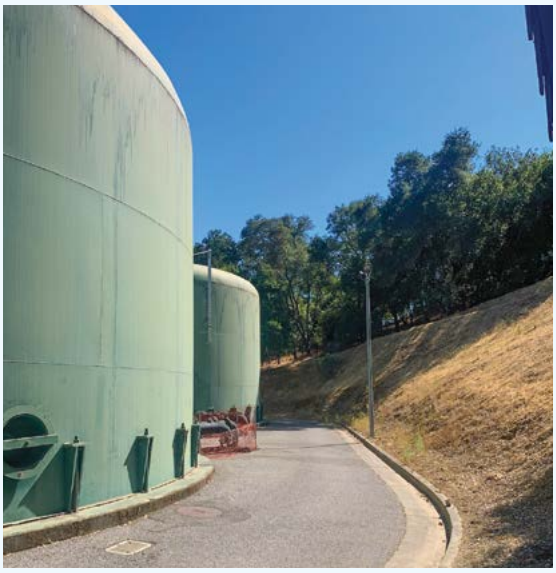
Sources of water

The City of Gilroy's drinking water is pumped from City wells that are connected to the groundwater in the Llagas Subbasin. Valley Water (Santa Clara Valley Water District) manages this regional groundwater basin by replenishing it with local reservoir releases and imported water supplies. Although Valley Water does not deliver treated drinking water directly to Gilroy, its groundwater management and recharge programs help ensure a reliable, high-quality water supply for the community.

The City of Gilroy operates and maintains its wells, pumps, and distribution system and is responsible for treating and delivering drinking water that meets all state and federal water quality standards. If you have any questions regarding this report or the water system, please contact the City's Information Desk at (408) 846-0219.

The City conducts monthly water quality testing at each of our nine wells to ensure safe drinking water for our community. Gilroy takes part in the required triennial lead and copper testing for drinking water, and the results consistently show extremely low levels.

The domestic water supplied by the City of Gilroy meets all current regulations.



This report contains important information about your drinking water. Scan the QR code or visit www.gilroy.city/water for the Spanish translation.

Este informe contiene información importante sobre su agua potable. Escanee el código QR o visite www.gilroy.city/water para la traducción al español.